



FREE GUIDE · UAE CLINICS & SERVICE BUSINESSES

The 24/7 WhatsApp Enquiry Playbook

A 10-minute self-audit, 16 copy-paste replies and a simple weekly scorecard so no customer enquiry waits until tomorrow. Everything here works with the free WhatsApp Business app.

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1. Why reply speed decides who gets the booking

Customers who message on WhatsApp are usually messaging your competitors too. The first business to give a clear, useful answer is usually the one that gets the visit, the rental or the quote request.

In Harvard Business Review's study of online sales leads, firms that contacted a lead within an hour were **nearly seven times as likely to qualify it** as firms that waited longer. 23% of firms never responded at all, and the median response time was 42 hours.

Source: J. Oldroyd, K. McElheran, D. Elkington, "The Short Life of Online Sales Leads", Harvard Business Review, March 2011
— hbr.org/2011/03/the-short-life-of-online-sales-leads

The gaps are predictable: evenings, Fridays, split-shift breaks, and the busiest hours when staff are with customers. This playbook closes those gaps first with free tools, then shows when automation is worth it.

2. The 10-minute self-audit

Tick what is already true. Each unticked box is a free fix.

- ☐ We use the **WhatsApp Business app** (free), not a personal WhatsApp account.
- ☐ Our **business profile** shows description, address, opening hours, email and website.
- ☐ A **greeting message** is switched on for first-time chats.
- ☐ An **away message** is switched on outside opening hours and says when we will reply.
- ☐ We have **quick replies** saved for our 10 most common questions.
- ☐ We use **labels** (New enquiry / Waiting for customer / Booked / Lost) to see what needs follow-up.
- ☐ Our services or products are in the **catalog** with a clear description.
- ☐ The WhatsApp number on our website is a **tap-to-chat link** (wa.me/971...) that works on phones.
- ☐ One named person is responsible for the WhatsApp inbox on every shift.
- ☐ We follow up every unanswered quote or booking request within 24 hours.
- ☐ We know roughly how many enquiries we get per week and how many become bookings.
- ☐ We know how many enquiries arrive outside opening hours.

Feature names from WhatsApp's own guide for small businesses: whatsappbusiness.com/resources/resource-library/small-business-use-whatsapp-business-app/

3. Greeting and away messages

GREETING (FIRST MESSAGE FROM A NEW CUSTOMER)

Hello and welcome to [Business name] 🖐️

To help you faster, please tell us:

- 1) what you need ([service A] / [service B] / [service C])
- 2) your preferred day and time
- 3) your name

We reply within [X] minutes during opening hours.

AWAY MESSAGE (OUTSIDE HOURS)

Thank you for your message! We're closed right now and open again at [time] on [day].

Leave your request here — what you need, preferred day/time and your name — and we'll reply first thing.

For emergencies please call [number].

AWAY MESSAGE — ARABIC

شكراً لتواصلك معنا! نحن خارج أوقات العمل حالياً، ونعود للعمل الساعة [الوقت] يوم [اليوم].
اترك طلبك هنا (الخدمة المطلوبة، الوقت المناسب، والاسم) وسنرد عليك أول شيء.

4. Sixteen quick replies to save today

In the WhatsApp Business app, save each as a quick reply with a shortcut (e.g. **/price**). Replace the brackets once; reuse forever.

/HOURS

We're open [days] from [time] to [time]. Would you like me to book a time for you?

/LOCATION

We're at [address] — here is the map: [Google Maps link]. Parking: [details].

/PRICE

Thanks for asking! [Service] starts from AED [X]. The exact price depends on [factor], and we'll confirm it before anything is booked. What date works for you?

/BOOK

Happy to book you in. Please send: 1) service, 2) preferred day and time, 3) your full name. We'll confirm the slot shortly.

/CONFIRM

You're confirmed for [service] on [day, date] at [time] at [branch]. Reply here if you need to change anything. See you then!

/REMIND (DAY BEFORE)

Friendly reminder: your appointment is tomorrow, [date] at [time]. Reply 1 to confirm or 2 to reschedule.

/INSURANCE (CLINICS)

We accept [list of insurers]. Please send a photo of the front of your card and we'll check your cover before the visit.

/URGENT

Sorry to hear that. I've marked this as urgent for our team — please call [number] now if it can't wait, or tell us the earliest time you can come.

/QUOTE (CONTRACTING/SERVICES)

To prepare your quote we need: location/area, type of work, approximate size, photos if possible, and when you'd like to start. We'll send the quote within [X] hours.

/DOCS (RENTALS)

For the booking we need a copy of your driving licence and Emirates ID/passport. Delivery or pickup — which do you prefer?

/PAY

You can pay by [card at branch / bank transfer / payment link]. We'll send a receipt right after payment.

/FOLLOWUP1 (NEXT DAY)

Hi [name], just checking you saw our reply about [service]. Would you like us to hold [day/time] for you?

/FOLLOWUP2 (3 DAYS)

Hi [name], we still have availability on [day]. If your plans changed, no problem — just let us know and we won't message again.

/BUSY

Thanks for your patience — we're with customers right now and will reply within [X] minutes.

/THANKS

Thank you for choosing [Business name]! If anything wasn't right, reply here and we'll fix it.

/STOP

Understood — we won't send further messages. Thank you, and you're always welcome to contact us again.

5. The follow-up rhythm

When	What	Label after
Within minutes (or away message)	Answer the question and ask for the one missing detail	New enquiry
Same day	Offer two specific slots or send the quote	Waiting for customer
Next day	/followup1	Waiting for customer
Day 3	/followup2 — then stop	Lost (note the reason)
Booked	/confirm, then /remind the day before	Booked

Only message people who contacted you first, and stop as soon as someone asks you to.

6. The weekly scorecard (5 numbers)

Number	How to count it	This week
New enquiries	Chats labelled "New enquiry"	
Out-of-hours enquiries	New chats that received the away message	
Typical first-reply time	Check 10 random chats: minutes from message to first real reply	
Bookings / quotes sent	Chats labelled "Booked" or quote sent	
Lost + top reason	Chats labelled "Lost"; most common note	

If out-of-hours enquiries are a large share of the total, or first-reply time is measured in hours, that is where the next booking is being lost.

7. When free tools stop being enough

The free app waits for a human. It is worth automating when:

- you get more enquiries than one person can answer quickly on a busy shift;
- many enquiries arrive at night, on Fridays or during breaks;
- staff type the same answers (prices, hours, documents, insurance) all day;
- quotes or bookings are lost because nobody followed up.

Want to see it on your own business? Send "DEMO" and your website to Mountain AI on WhatsApp (+971 56 777 3366). Within 24 hours we'll send a private working demo of an assistant set up with the services on your website, free and with no obligation. If you want it live, the 14-day pilot is a fixed AED 1,500, credited in full if you continue.

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